

Microsoft 365 — App Registration for Mailbox (Email-to-Ticket)

One Helpdesk / Ticketing Platform
Setup guide for the Project Lead

What this is for

This app lets the helpdesk **connect to a Microsoft 365 mailbox** so it can:

- **Pull incoming email into tickets** (IMAP), and
- **Send replies from that mailbox** (SMTP).

Microsoft has retired Basic Authentication for IMAP/SMTP, so the connection uses **OAuth 2.0**. You register an app in Microsoft Entra (Azure AD), grant it the mail permissions, and paste its details into the mailbox screen — the same way you would configure any modern mail integration.

This is a different app from the “Sign in with Microsoft” (SSO) app. Register a separate app for mailboxes. See the companion guide *Azure App for SSO*.

Who performs this: a person who is both an **Exchange administrator** (to enable the mailbox protocols) and can **register an app** in Entra (Application Administrator / Global Administrator).

Before you start — collect two things

1. **The mailbox address** you want the helpdesk to use, e.g. `support@yourcompany.com` (a shared or licensed mailbox).
2. **The Redirect URI** — this is **always shown in the helpdesk settings**; don't type it by hand. Open the workspace's **Settings** → **Mailboxes** → **(add/edit a mailbox)** → **Connection**, choose **Microsoft 365 (OAuth)**, and use the **Copy** button next to **Redirect URI**. You'll paste this value into Azure in Part B, and again to confirm it in Part C. Always copy the **current** value from Settings — Microsoft matches it character-for-character, so an exact copy matters.

Part A — Prepare the mailbox in Exchange (one-time)

OAuth still requires the mailbox's IMAP and authenticated-SMTP protocols to be switched on. In the **Microsoft 365 admin / Exchange admin center**, or via Exchange Online PowerShell:

```
# Connect first: Connect-ExchangeOnline

# Enable IMAP + authenticated SMTP for the mailbox
Set-CASMailbox -Identity support@yourcompany.com `
  -ImapEnabled $true `
  -SmtpClientAuthenticationDisabled $false

# If authenticated SMTP is disabled tenant-wide, allow it
```

```
# (or scope per-mailbox as above):  
Set-TransportConfig -SmtpClientAuthenticationDisabled $false
```

- If your tenant uses **Security Defaults** or **Conditional Access**, make sure they don't block OAuth token issuance for this app / mailbox.
- No change to the mailbox password is needed — OAuth replaces password auth.

Part B — Register the app in Microsoft Entra

Step 1 — Create the registration

1. Go to the [Microsoft Entra admin center](#) (or the [Azure Portal](#) → **Microsoft Entra ID**).
2. **App registrations** → **+ New registration**.
3. **Name:** e.g. `Helpdesk Mailbox Connector`.
4. **Supported account types:** **Accounts in this organizational directory only (Single tenant)**.
5. **Redirect URI:** platform **Web** → paste the **Redirect URI** you copied above.
6. Click **Register**.

Step 2 — Copy the two IDs

On the app's **Overview** page, copy:

- **Application (client) ID** — a GUID.
- **Directory (tenant) ID** — a GUID.

Step 3 — Add the mail permissions

1. Open **API permissions** → **+ Add a permission** → **APIs my organization uses**.
2. Search for and select **Office 365 Exchange Online**.
3. Choose **Delegated permissions** and tick:
 - **IMAP.AccessAsUser.All** (read the inbox)
 - **SMTP.Send** (send replies)
4. Click **Add permissions**.
5. Add **Microsoft Graph** → **Delegated** → **offline_access** the same way (lets the helpdesk refresh the connection without re-consenting). `openid` / `User.Read` are fine to leave as-is.
6. Click **Grant admin consent for <your tenant>** and confirm. (Admin consent avoids a per-user consent prompt and is required for the IMAP permission.)

Step 4 — Create a client secret

1. **Certificates & secrets** → **Client secrets** → **+ New client secret**.
2. Add a description and an expiry (e.g. 24 months). Click **Add**.
3. **Immediately copy the secret Value** (not the *Secret ID*). It is shown only once.

Copy the **Value** column. The *Secret ID* will **not** work.

Part C — Enter the details in the helpdesk

1. In the helpdesk, go to the workspace's **Settings** → **Mailboxes** and add/edit the mailbox.
2. On the **Connection** tab, set **Authentication** to **Microsoft 365 (OAuth)** and enter:
 - **Application (client) ID** — from Step 2
 - **Directory (tenant) ID** — from Step 2
 - **Client secret** — the **Value** from Step 4
 - **Mailbox address / username** — e.g. `support@yourcompany.com`
3. Confirm the **Redirect URI** shown matches what you registered in Step 1.
4. Click **Connect mailbox**. A Microsoft sign-in opens — **sign in as the mailbox account** (or an admin authorising it) and accept the consent. Tokens are then stored (encrypted) and the mailbox shows **Connected**.
5. Use **Test connection** (inbound IMAP) and **Test SMTP** (outbound) to verify, then save. Optionally **Poll now** to pull mail immediately.

Values to hand over

From Entra	Goes into the mailbox's Connection tab
Application (client) ID	Client ID
Directory (tenant) ID	Directory (tenant) ID
Client secret Value	Client secret
Redirect URI (copied from Settings)	register it in Entra → Authentication

Inbound server `outlook.office365.com:993` (SSL) and outbound `smtp.office365.com:587` (STARTTLS) are filled in automatically for Microsoft 365.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause / fix
<code>AADSTS50011: redirect URI does not match</code>	The Redirect URI in Entra differs from the one on the mailbox screen. Copy it again exactly (including the trailing <code>/</code>).
<code>AADSTS7000215: Invalid client secret</code>	You used the Secret ID instead of the Value , or the secret expired. Create a new secret and paste its Value .
"Connected" but Test connection fails on IMAP	IMAP not enabled for the mailbox — run <code>Set-CASMailbox -ImapEnabled \$true</code> ; confirm IMAP.AccessAsUser.All is granted with admin consent.
Test SMTP fails / <code>SmtpClientAuthentication</code> is disabled	Enable authenticated SMTP (<code>Set-CASMailbox -SmtpClientAuthenticationDisabled \$false</code> ,

Symptom	Likely cause / fix
	and org-level <code>Set-TransportConfig</code>). Confirm SMTP.Send is granted.
Consent screen says admin approval required	Click Grant admin consent on the app's API permissions page.
Connection drops after a few weeks	The client secret expired . Create a new secret in Entra and paste the new Value into the mailbox screen.

Security notes

- The mailbox uses a **single-tenant** app, so only your organisation's directory can issue tokens.
- The client secret and the mailbox tokens are stored **encrypted** and are never shown back in the UI.
- Rotate the **client secret** before its expiry date to avoid an outage.